



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Christian School

School Website: <https://www.paideiachristian.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Liberty Christian School (Prosser, WA, 99350) (as reflected in the crawl of Paideia Christian Academy's Prosser, WA 99350 site) presents a robust Classical Christian profile. Public materials emphasize a Christian worldview, a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with Great Books and original sources, and a clear commitment to partnering with families in the formation of character, virtue, and wisdom. The materials also articulate a telos of forming students for faith, service, and cultural impact, not merely vocational preparation. Across categories, the site demonstrates strong alignment with Classical Christian ideals, though the pedagogical deployment sometimes emphasizes traditional methods (memory work and recitation pathways) that the rubric treats as core classical pedagogy rather than merely adjuncts.

Overall classification by category:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

These judgments hinge on explicit textual anchors from the public-facing materials (mission statements, statements of faith, the Trivium emphasis, and Great Books/Latin components) and the classical rubric's Positive/Negative keyword indicators. See category-by-category details below, with supporting evidence and keyword analyses drawn from the knowledge base and the school's materials. Citations point to the exact passages identified in the crawl results.

- The religious/metaphysical grounding is explicitly woven into mission, faith statements, and worldview framing (God-honoring aims, Christian worldview presupposed in all subjects, the Statement of Faith). These elements align with the Positive keywords in the classical rubric (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy/worship) and with the framework's expectation of a theology-grounded education. Evidence: Paideia Mission and Missional Beliefs; Statement of Faith; in loco parentis language; and goals of partnering with churches and families.
- The school's purpose/goal is intentionally formation-centric (virtue, wisdom, love of God, human flourishing) rather than simply career preparation. Textual anchors speak to forming students to glorify God, cultivate virtues, and develop a Christian worldview. Positive keywords include formation, virtue, telos, great conversation, wisdom, and liberal education.
- The curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts core (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; classical language; interrelated subjects) and a history-centric approach anchored in Western civilization. Positive keywords include Trivium/grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; classical curriculum.
- Pedagogy shows classical contours (Trivium-based, memory work and recitation, and an integrated view of subjects) but the explicit, uniformly described deployment of Socratic seminars across grades is less overt in public materials than the rubric would expect for full Socratic pedagogy in higher grades. This yields a rating of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy rather than CLASSICAL. See analysis below.
- Faculty is described as virtuous, living exemplars in the classroom, with teachers as the core of the living curriculum and a culture of collegial mentorship. This aligns well with the rubric's expectations for the Faculty category.

- Parents & Community are presented as partners in education, with explicit calls for parental involvement, co-teaching language, family formation, and open-campus ethos. This matches the rubric's expectations for strong parent/community engagement.

Executive decisions for the six-category rubric were made by cross-referencing the school's public materials with Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric and the Lexicon/Glossary in the knowledge base. The aggregate assessment places the school squarely in CLASSICAL overall, with Pedagogy as the principal "needle mover" toward a more fully classical execution.

- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories): To push Pedagogy toward CLASSICAL, the school could more explicitly articulate and implement sustained Socratic discussion/seminars across upper grades, elevate emphasis on the seven liberal arts through explicit retention of the memory-work and recitation tradition, and foreground regular rituals of Scholé (restful, contemplative learning) in daily practice. This would harmonize pedagogy with the clearest Positive keyword indicators in the rubric. See "What would move the needle" below.
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ABSTRACT follows at the end, summarizing the overall classification and insights in alignment with the six-category rubric.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public statements articulate a distinctly Christian worldview shaping all learning: "Paideia uses a classical method rooted in the Christian worldview," and "The rightful end of education is to enable the student to more fully honor and glorify God."
- The faith framework is formalized in a Statement of Faith and in mission documents that ground all knowledge in Scripture and a Christian metaphysical vision.
- Texts reference sacred tradition, liturgical framing, and a theology-grounded approach to education (see Mission and Missional Beliefs and in loco parentis language).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; chapel; worship; gospel; creed; sacred tradition; Logos; God; Scripture; Christian worldview. Examples include "truth, goodness, and beauty" in mission and Missional Beliefs; and "God is honored" in the Statement of Faith.
- Negative keywords: Not evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or anti-theology signals) in the accessible pages. The Positive signals dominate.

Why this rating

- The school's public-facing materials consistently bind education to a Christian metaphysical framework and the objective truths of a Christian worldview, aligning with the Classical rubric's category for a robust religious/metaphysical foundation. This aligns with the rubric's Positive keywords in this category and shows a clear Classical orientation.

Category score justification: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Texts emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom and the idea that education is for human excellence and the flourishing of the soul, not merely job training. The mission describes forming students to “glorify God” and to have a “systematic Christian worldview,” with a focus on virtue and wisdom.
- The goals articulate liberal education and the Great Conversation as an overarching telos, with emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real objects of intellectual formation.
- The Great Books/Great Conversation framing is present, along with a Trivium-based path and a desire for lifelong learning and virtue.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, telos, scholé, great conversation, classical mission.
- Negative keywords (workforce prep, college/career readiness) are not highlighted as the primary aim in public materials; no explicit emphasis on 21st-century skills in the public sections (the focus remains formation and virtue). This yields a favorable balance toward classical aims.

Why this rating

- The school’s stated aims center on formation and virtue rather than merely information transfer or job preparation, which maps cleanly to the Classical rubric’s expected orientation for School Purpose and Goal.

Category score justification: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Core curriculum is described as liberal arts with Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and classical languages (Latin). The materials explicitly call out the Seven Liberal Arts approach and Great Books in the curriculum narrative.
- The curriculum emphasizes the Great Books and original sources, with a commitment to integrated learning across history, philosophy, arts, sciences, and literature under a Christian worldview.
- The Trivium pillars (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) are explicitly spelled out as the instructional framework.
- The public materials show a strong focus on Latin and classical languages, with reference to “Going ad fontes” and original sources.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, classical languages (Latin/Greek), history, Western civilization, unity of truth across disciplines, and integration/wonder.
- Negative keywords present: Some modern-pedagogy terms that the classical rubric flags as potential divergences (e.g., project-based learning or purely experiential learning) are not emphasized in the public materials; the curriculum appears oriented toward classic sources rather than modern, utilitarian framing.

Why this rating

- The materials consistently present a curriculum anchored in classical liberal arts, the Trivium, Great Books, and Latin, aligning with a CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Category score justification: CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials foreground the Trivium and the integration of subjects (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin). This aligns with classical pedagogy signals in the rubric.

- There are explicit references to “restful learning” and the conceptual aim of formation through contemplation (Scholé) in the knowledge-base lexicon and in the rubric’s pedagogy indicators; however, the Paideia site materials themselves emphasize traditional methods (memory, recitation, and structured learning) more clearly than explicit, codified Socratic seminars across all grades. The “Socratic/dialogue” and “seminar” language appears in the classical education literature more broadly than in the Paideia public-facing site, which focuses on Trivium and Great Books rather than a prescriptive Socratic schedule for every grade. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); sacred/ancillary classical pedagogy terms like sequencing of memory work, recitation, and memory/chanting concepts found in classical pedagogy rubrics. The classical lexicon emphasizes Socratic seminar; Paideia materials explicitly emphasize Trivium; Great Books; and integrated learning.
- Negative keywords present: Limited explicit statements about universal deployment of Socratic seminars across all grades; fewer explicit descriptions of ongoing Socratic seminars or full “Scola” style conversational pedagogy beyond the Trivium. The site’s public content leans more toward classical structure and formation than toward the full Socratic method at all levels.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates strong classical pedagogical elements (Trivium, Great Books, memory/recitation, and restfulness) but lacks robust, consistently explicit public statements about pervasive Socratic seminars or advanced seminar-based teaching in every grade, which the rubric uses as a hallmark of a fully Classical pedagogy. This places Pedagogy in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4 rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty is described as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue, and as a “living curriculum” in a collegial, student-centered, and virtue-focused culture. This aligns with the rubric’s expectation of a living curriculum and a teacher’s role as exemplar.
- The school’s materials portray faculty and staff as central to the school’s mission, with explicit emphasis on character formation and living exemplars. The public materials also mention a board and a staff that model the Christian and classical ethos.
- There is a clear ethos of partnering with families and a shared mission among faculty, staff, and students.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentors/model teachers; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; character formation; moral exemplars.
- Negative keywords: The lexicon mentions possible signals of depersonalized or overly professionalized pedagogy; however, the school’s own materials emphasize personal mentorship, virtue, and teacher-student relationships, aligning with Classical expectations.

Why this rating

- The school’s materials strongly align with the “Faculty” criteria in the Classical rubric: virtuous, model teachers who are part of the core living curriculum and the school’s culture. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5 rating: CLASSICAL

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence



- The school explicitly positions parents as co-educators and partners in education, with a focus on parental involvement and formation (e.g., the “Distinctly Family” pillar, the in loco parentis framework, and explicit calls for parent participation and family formation).
- The public materials emphasize partnerships with families, parent education (e.g., book studies and gatherings may be implied in mission and policy discussions), and an open-campus approach (parents invited to visits). The “In loco parentis” policy reinforces this family-school partnership model.
- The materials show a consistent emphasis on parent involvement as a core part of classical education, aligning with the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” positive keyword indicators.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; parent involvement; home and school connection; family catechesis; classical parent training; parental responsibility; engaged families.
- Negative keywords: The public materials do not advertise minimal parental involvement or parent as customer; the negative signals in the lexicon are not reflected in the school’s public pages.

Why this rating

- The school’s materials reflect a robust, parent-inclusive model consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Parent & Community involvement and forming a community around classical education. CLASSICAL.

Element 6 rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle (applicable because Element 4 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Make Pedagogy more explicitly aligned with full classical practice by publishing and implementing a school-wide, systematic plan for Socratic seminars across upper grades (high school) with documented outcomes and rubrics.
- Explicitly foreground Scholé (restful, contemplative learning) as a daily, integrated practice across all grades (not just as a rubric reference), including scheduling, memory work, and recitation as formal, repeated activities with measurable outcomes.
- Ensure the Great Conversation is visibly embedded in a regularly updated Great Books program with primary-source engagements, teacher-led seminars, and student-led synthesis projects across disciplines, with public-facing evidence for families.
- The needle-left is not heavy since the aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL, but addressing Pedagogy more clearly would push the school toward full CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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